At the higher level, the amount of folate lost by the mother would be about 25µg a day. An additional allowance of 100µg of folate should be provided during lactation.

e) Fluid

An increase intake of fluid is necessary for adequate milk production, since milk is a fluid tissue. Water and beverages such as juices, soups, buttermilk and milk, all add to the fluid necessary to produce milk. A lactating mother should take 2-3 litres of fluid per day.



Human milk boost a baby's immune system big time helping baby fight viral, bacterial, and parasitic infections including respiratory tract infections, ear infections, bacterial meningitis, pneumonia, urinary tract infections, infant diarrhoea, common cold and flu.

2.2.3 Dietary guidelines

- "**Galactogogue"** or lactogogue act by increasing the prolactin secretion which in turn increases milk production. They also work psychologically and have a marginal effect on milk production. Sucking is the best lactogogue. The diet can include lactogogues, which stimulate the production of milk. Garlic, milk, almonds, and garden cress seeds are considered to increase the milk production in certain regions of India.
- Weight gain beyond that desirable for body size, should be avoided. When the baby is weaned, the mother must reduce her food intake in order that obesity may be avoided.
- It is better to control constipation by inclusion in the diet of raw and cooked fruits and vegetables, whole grains and an adequate amount of water than by use of laxatives.
- No food need be withheld from the mother unless it causes distress to the infant. Occasionally, tomatoes, onions, members of cabbage family, chocolate, spices and condiments may cause gastric distress or loose stools in the infant.



Activity : 4

Suggest a few recipes that promotes milk production.

2.2.4 Practice incompatible with lactation

Some substance impair milk production or enter breast milk and interfere with infant development. Some medical condition prohibit breastfeeding. This section describes these circumstances.

a) Alcohol

Alcohol easily enters breast milk, and its concentration peaks within an hour of ingestion. Infants drink less breast milk when their mother have consumed even small amount of alcohol.

b) Medical drugs

Many drugs are compatible with breastfeeding, but some medicines are contraindicated, either because they suppress lactation or because they are secreted into breast milk and can harm the infant.

c) Illicit drug

Illicit drugs of course are harmful to the physical and emotional health of both the mother and the nursing infant. Breast milk can deliver such high dose of illicit drugs as to cause irritability, tremors, hallucination and even death in infants.

d) Smoking

Cigarette smoking reduces milk volume, smokers may produce too little milk to meet their infant's energy needs. Consequently infants of breast feeding mothers who smoke gain less weight whereas infant's of those who do not smoke.

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